
DOMINIONS 6 NATION DOSSIER

Early Age T'ien Ch'i

Spring and Autumn

Progress Edition 31

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Unmodded 6.37 doctrine with source-labelled rules, strategy, and open verification work.

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Early Age T'ien Ch'i: Spring and Autumn

Early Age T'ien Ch'i one-page command brief

Early Age T'ien Ch'i converts human combined arms, noble commanders, Masters of the Way, and broad but distributed elemental magic into expansion, research, and strategic pressure. The pinned roster resolves 9 commander identities and 11 troop identities across ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment, plus 12 active nation-restricted spell records. Its chief planning risks are mage-path fragmentation, capital pressure, army coordination, and matching research to the casters actually recruited.

The safe operating plan is to keep recruitment geography visible, buy commanders for named jobs, label every random mage, connect research to casters already owned, and preserve a replacement route before committing elite or capital-limited troops. Exact expansion parties, scripts, formations, spell targets, freespawn composition, transformation results, and combat outcomes remain open unless a source below states them directly.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i evidence and ruleset

This dossier covers unmodded Early Age T'ien Ch'i on the Dominions 6.37 executable baseline. Player-facing rules are governed by the revision-2 official manual and official patches through 9 September 2026. Nation ID 22, roster memberships, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments are cross-checked against the pinned Inspector 6.35 commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bffb036ba9bd5dc.

The structured snapshot is not relabelled as live 6.37 data. The 6.37 patch's unspecified statistic corrections are not assigned to any T'ien Ch'i object without a named official record. No runtime test, replay, save, or new test asset was used.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i conversion chain

verified recruitment and national assets

-> provinces, forts, laboratories, temples, scouts, and replacement routes

-> labelled fixed and random path access

-> research, searching, forging, rituals, and battlefield support

-> surviving armies, sieges, claims, raids, and strategic depth

Early Age T'ien Ch'i recruitment geography

Recruitment layer	Commanders	Troops	Evidence boundary
Ordinary forts	5	10	Direct pinned membership rows
Regional or coastal	3	0	Non-fort and coast membership rows; exact terrain availability remains source-dependent
Site-linked	2	1	Explicit site recruit fields; capital grouping follows the nation-site association

Empty ordinary rows do not prove that a nation lacks forces. Freespawn, reanimation, events, summoning, dominion effects, and special recruitment remain separate mechanisms.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i commander roster

ID	Commander	Fixed and random magic	Leadership
426	Scout	none	0
1665	Noble Commander	none	100
806	Master of the Dead	D1 H1	10
3936	Student of the Way	W1; random: 100% x1 mask 26880 link 1	10
4022	Student of the Sword	none; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1	10
3935	Master of the Way	W1; random: 100% x2 mask 27392 link 1	10
3937	Student of the Five Elements	none; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1	10
940	Master of the Five Elements	F1 A1 W1 E1 N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1	10
941	Celestial Master	F1 A1 W2 S1 G1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 13440 link 1; 100% x1 mask 19200 link 1; 10% x1 mask 19200 link 1	10

Early Age T'ien Ch'i troop roster

ID	Unit	HP	Protection	Morale	Traits
794	Footman	10	0	10	ordinary body
795	Footman	10	0	10	ordinary body
796	Footman	10	0	10	ordinary body
797	Archer	10	0	10	ordinary body
1901	Medium Footman	10	0	10	ordinary body
1904	Medium Footman	10	0	10	ordinary body
928	Heavy Footman	10	0	10	ordinary body
929	Heavy Footman	10	0	10	ordinary body
788	Horseman	10	0	10	ordinary body
927	Noble	12	0	13	ordinary body
1544	Warrior of the Five Elements	12	5	15	sacred

Early Age T'ien Ch'i mage and priest portfolio

ID	Commander	Fixed and random magic	Leadership
806	Master of the Dead	D1 H1	10
3936	Student of the Way	W1; random: 100% x1 mask 26880 link 1	10
4022	Student of the Sword	none; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1	10
3935	Master of the Way	W1; random: 100% x2 mask 27392 link 1	10
3937	Student of the Five Elements	none; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1	10

ID	Commander	Fixed and random magic	Leadership
940	Master of the Five Elements	F1 A1 W1 E1 N1 H1; random: 100% x1 mask 10112 link 1	10
941	Celestial Master	F1 A1 W2 S1 G1 H2; random: 100% x1 mask 13440 link 1; 100% x1 mask 19200 link 1; 10% x1 mask 19200 link 1	10

The highest fixed recruitable paths resolved in these rows are Fire 1, Air 1, Water 2, Earth 1, Astral 1, Death 1, Nature 1, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Random masks are printed as raw pinned fields because mask interpretation, linked-roll behaviour, and live display should not be guessed. A rare result is an opportunity after recruitment, never a guaranteed research or ritual schedule.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i capital and national sites

ID	Site	Monthly fields	Recruits recorded
53	The Bamboo Grove	no gem field	Master of the Five Elements, Warrior of the Five Elements
54	The Gate of Spring and Autumn	F1, W2, S2, D1	Celestial Master

Site rows prove only their explicit fields. Hidden effects, event behaviour, recruitment timing, ownership transitions, and live interface grouping remain unresolved.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i national spell map

ID	Spell	School	Requirement	Cost field
286	Celestial Chastisement	Evocation 5	S3	0
287	Contact Huli Jing	Conjuration 6	N2	30
289	Internal Alchemy	Alteration 5	W2 S1	5
529	Celestial Servant	Conjuration 1	E1 S1	1
530	Heavenly Rivers	Conjuration 3	W1 S1	9
531	Celestial Hounds	Conjuration 4	A1 S1	2
532	Heavenly Fires	Conjuration 5	F1 S1	4
533	Call Celestial Soldiers	Conjuration 6	A2 S1	15
534	Call Ancestor	Conjuration 1	D1	0
535	Wrath of the Ancestors	Conjuration 7	D1	1
957	Ambush of Tigers	Conjuration 3	N2	9
958	Herd of Buffaloes	Conjuration 3	N2	8

Research does not create the caster, gems, slaves, corpses, laboratory, target, or free mage-turn. Every national spell remains a gated project: research, access, treasury, legal target, and opportunity cost must all be present.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i national item boundary

ID	Item	Construction	Paths	Link
138	Sword of the Five Elements	3	F1 W1	restricted
284	Armor of the Five Elements	3	E1 A1	restricted
288	Chi Shoes	3	A1	rebate

Restriction and rebate fields establish metadata links, not displayed prices, rounding, stacking, or live forge availability. Those remain open unless the official manual supplies the exact result.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i hero boundary

ID	Hero record	Magic	Boundary
942	Immortal	A1 N2	assignment only; timing unresolved
943	Immortal	F1 A1 W2 S3 H2	assignment only; timing unresolved
944	Master With The Iron Crutch	A2 S2 D2	assignment only; timing unresolved

Heroes are contingent capacity. None belongs in an opening, research, or path plan that must work every game.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i army identities

- Sacred roster: Warrior of the Five Elements.
- Flying roster: no flying troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Aquatic or amphibious roster: no aquatic or amphibious troop identified in the reconciled recruit rows.
- Core identity: human combined arms, noble commanders, Masters of the Way, and broad but distributed elemental magic.

These labels help assemble testable packages; they do not establish the best formation, script, bless, target, or casualty rate.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i opening and expansion controls

- 1 Identify whether gold, resources, recruitment points, commander points, corpses, population, slaves, or a special national mechanism limits the first queue.
- 2 Separate ordinary, regional, coastal, and site-linked recruitment before planning reinforcement.
- 3 Use mundane leadership where it preserves a valuable mage-turn.
- 4 Label random mages immediately and keep rare paths out of guaranteed schedules.
- 5 Add scouts and retreat routes before extending beyond reliable information.
- 6 Record expansion results rather than publishing an untested party size.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i fort and recruitment doctrine

Additional forts are valuable when they reproduce the commander or troop required by the next job. Regional and coastal recruitment must be evaluated where it exists rather than averaged into a fictional universal roster. Capital or site-linked units need a replacement ledger because their opportunity cost competes with every other capital-limited purchase.

For T'ien Ch'i, the most likely planning failure is mage-path fragmentation, capital pressure, army coordination, and matching research to the casters actually recruited. The remedy is a visible queue showing location, bottleneck, expected role, and replacement time.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i research response tree

- Fixed-path branch: begin with spells the repeatable mage roster can cast without a random, booster, hero, or Pretender.
- Random-path branch: open only after the qualifying mage is recruited and labelled.
- National-spell branch: verify the exact research level, caster, cost, target, and free mage-turn from the spell table.
- Construction branch: compare each forge turn against research, searching, ritual work, and army support; item metadata alone does not prove a discount.
- Summon or reanimation branch: account for gems, corpses, slaves, laboratory access, leadership, and unresolved arrival behaviour.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i magic-access ladder

The fixed-path ceiling is Fire 1, Air 1, Water 2, Earth 1, Astral 1, Death 1, Nature 1, Glamour 1, Holy 2. Access above that line needs a named bridge: booster, empowerment, communion or chorus where legal, summoned mage, hero, Pretender, or another directly verified source. Two partial paths on different commanders cannot be combined to cast one spell.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i battlefield packages

Line and support package

Use the most replaceable suitable troops as frontage, place commanders according to actual leadership, and protect mages whose turns are needed for research or rituals. Armour, morale, fatigue, size, formation width, and the opponent decide whether the line survives.

Elite or sacred package

Use sacred or elite troops only when their recruitment location, bless, priest coverage, and replacement rate justify the commitment. Capital scarcity is a strategic cost even when the unit performs well.

Mobility or habitat package

Flying, stealthy, sailing, aquatic, amphibious, cave, forest, or wasteland tools must be checked against legal movement, supply, retreat, and reinforcement. A trait is not permission to ignore geography.

Mage package

Script from paths actually present on the recruited commanders. Keep gem use, fatigue, friendly fire, magic resistance, battlefield size, and enemy resistances visible; no generic script is treated as verified performance.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i Pretender families

Family	What it can solve	What it cannot conceal
Missing-path bridge	Opens a named booster, ritual, or battlefield threshold	Research, gems, laboratories, and mage-turns remain required
Economy and infrastructure	Funds forts, laboratories, temples, commanders, and replacements	Gold does not create local resources, gems, corpses, slaves, or commander points
Sacred support	Improves a verified sacred package	Recruitment limits, priest coverage, and counters remain
Awake expansion body	Reduces pressure on the starting roster	Performance depends on settings, map, chassis, scales, script, and opponents
Resistance package	Covers a documented roster weakness	One resistance is not universal defence

Early Age T'ien Ch'i matchup and failure matrix

Enemy problem	First answer to examine	Avoid
Massed light units	Replaceable width, area effects, morale pressure, and reserves	Spending every scarce elite turn on basic frontage
Heavy armour	Higher damage, armour-piercing or negating magic, fatigue, and buffs	Assuming ordinary weapons solve protection unaided
Accurate missiles	Screens, protection, spacing, speed, and disruption	Exposing commanders or fragile elites without guards
Elemental resistance	Shift damage type and use physical or fatigue pressure	Building the complete research plan around one element
Fast raiders or flyers	Scouts, local leadership, layered defence, and mobile reserves	Concentrating every commander in one army
Large targets	Concentrated attacks, debuffs, control, and size-aware counters	Treating trampling or low-damage swarms as universal
Underwater or land transition	Verified amphibious access, coastal staging, summons, or allies	Assuming a habitat transition works because a related unit can cross

Early Age T'ien Ch'i monthly audit

- Which recruitment layer supplies each current army and mage role?
- What is the active bottleneck at every fort?
- Are random mages labelled and excluded from guaranteed schedules until present?
- Does each research target have a legal caster and treasury?
- Are capital, coastal, regional, freespawn, and ordinary replacements tracked separately?
- Are scouts, laboratories, temples, leadership, supply, and retreat routes keeping pace?
- Are heroes excluded from plans that must work every game?
- Have uncertain mechanics remained marked as uncertain?

Early Age T'ien Ch'i unresolved evidence boundary

The dossier does not claim exact expansion counts, formation performance, script outcomes, random-path display, freespawn or reanimation composition, special-dominion timing, transformation or mount resolution, summon arrival state, item-price stacking, hero timing, stealth detection, sailing routes, underwater transition, event outcomes, or battlefield casualty ranges. Nation-specific mechanics implied by names or summaries remain qualitative unless an explicit source field settles them. R-047, R-058, and every comparable engine-dependent investigation remain parked.

Early Age T'ien Ch'i source note

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: nation summary, visible roster, recruitment markings, national rules, and spell descriptions.
- Official Dominions patch history through 6.37: current executable chronology; generic 6.37 statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed objects.
- Dominions 6 Data Inspector commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc: nation ID, membership rows, unit fields, random masks, sites, spell restrictions, item links, and hero assignments.
- Strategy sections are bounded doctrine derived from verified capacity. They are not runtime test results.

Dossier source register

Official

- Dominions 6 Manual, revision 2: all 37 unmodded Middle Age nation pages; national spells and rituals; research; communions, Chorus, and Grand Communion; Blood and crossbreeding; Inquisition; mounts; sailing; flying; forging; habitat transitions; and fort construction.
- Illwinter official patch history through 6.37, including the current Send Aatxe restriction, communion corrections, the 6.13 Forest of Avalon Magic correction, the 6.01 Abysia wall-defender note, Eriu's 6.01 terrain-recruit and Bean Sidhe corrections, Agartha's 6.04 Oracle-shape note, and 6.37's bounded research, drowning, and Drake corrections. Generic statistic fixes are not assigned to unnamed nation objects.

Structured snapshot

- Dominions 6 Data Inspector, commit cfac4311bc0b58053b8dead7bfffbc036ba9bd5dc, pinned to the 6.35 data update; used for mage random masks, recruitment records, capital sites, national spell restrictions, national item fields, and current object cross-checks.

Interpretation boundary

Roster entries, path masks, costs, site income, item restrictions, and national ritual requirements are source facts. Openings, research trees, Pretender families, battlefield packages, and matchup advice are strategy. Expansion counts, random-result timing, Blood returns, crossbreeding outputs, displayed forge-cost stacking, communion and Grand Communion outcomes, hydra-field behaviour, Spell Singer outcomes, Glamour detection, special-dominion scaling and targeting, ancestor-summon behaviour, conscription output, variable summon quantities, retinue and shape behaviour, flying and storm resolution, ice-equipment scaling, Guardian Spirit behaviour, remote ritual outcomes, spell targeting, and combat outcomes remain observation questions until a versioned raw set is published.